Republic of the Philippines
Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
BANGSAMORO TRANSITION AUTHORITY PARLIAMENT
Bangsamoro Government Center, Cotabato City

FIRST REGULAR SESSION

RESOLUTION NO. 317

RESOLUTION EXPRESSING THE PROFOUND GRIEF OF THE BTA PARLIAMENT ON THE PASSING AWAY OF PHILIPPINE AMBASSADOR AKMAD ATLAH SAKKAM, PHILIPPINE AMBASSADOR TO THE HASHEMITE KINGDOM OF JORDAN AND ITS SYMPATHIES TO HIS BEREAVED FAMILY, AND TO RECOGNIZE HIS CONTRIBUTIONS TO THE BANGSAMORO

WHEREAS, on February 08, 2023/*Rajab* 17, 1444, Ambassador Akmad Atlah Sakkam, Philippine Ambassador Extraordinary and Plenipotentiary to the Hashemite Kingdom of Jordan with concurrent jurisdiction over the State of Palestine, has returned to the Mercy of the Almighty Allah *(S.W.T.);*

WHEREAS, Ambassador Sakkam had previously served as Philippine Ambassador to Iraq (1986-1992), Bahrain (1994-1999) and Oman (1999-2003);

WHEREAS, his career as a diplomat spanned more than two decades and he had served under five different administrations;

WHEREAS, as Ambassador, he was awarded a Special Presidential Award of Merit by President Corazon Aquino for his role in the successful evacuation of thousands of Filipino workers in Kuwait and Iraq during the first Gulf War of 1991;

WHEREAS, the Department of Foreign Affairs awarded him the Distinguished Service Award in 2012 in cognizance of "the highest degree of professionalism and substantial contribution to the advancement of the national interests abroad in the areas of bilateral, regional and multilateral relations";

WHEREAS, as a former member of the Bangsamoro Transition Commission from 2014-2016, he was instrumental in the crafting of the original version of the Bangsamoro Basic Law (BBL);

WHEREAS, as a Tausug, a Moro, who hailed from the towns of Indanan and Patikul, he advocated the advancement of the Bangsamoro cause and our inherent right to self-determination;

WHEREAS, Sakkam has lived a meaningful life and has brought honor and pride not only to the Tausugs but to the whole Bangsamoro. His contributions to the government service especially his dedication and hard work in drafting the BBL are immeasurable;

WHEREAS, his demise is an immense loss to the Bangsamoro and the Philippine nation as a whole;

WHEREAS, his bereaved family can find comfort and strength in knowing that the Bangsamoro people join them in mourning and in prayers and in trusting that Ambassador Sakkam has returned to his Creator for "to Allah (Almighty God) we belong, and to Him is our return." (Qur'an 2:156):

NOW, THEREFORE, be it

RESOLVED, as it is hereby resolved by the Bangsamoro Transition Authority, To express its profound grief on the passing away of Ambassador Akmad Atlah Sakkam, Philippine Ambassador to the Hashemite Kingdom of Jordan and its sympathies to his bereaved family, and to recognize his

contributions to the Bangsamoro.

RESOLVED, FURTHER, To present the foregoing Resolution to the bereaved family of Ambassador Akmad Atlah Sakkam, for information.

ADOPTED, *Rajab* 26, 1444/February 17, 2023.

Certified Correct:

PROF. RABY B. ANGKAL
Secretary-General

Attested:

ATTY. PANGALIAN M. BALINDONG
Speaker

/CON: PR176 and PR177